



"A good PR story is better than a front page ad."

Sir Richard Branson, entrepreneur

Spreading the word

Generating publicity need not be expensive, especially if your customer base is local. Identify your target customers (see pp.40–41) and develop publicity and PR activities with them in mind. Most people like promotions, with special deals and free giveaways, but some may respond better to information via direct mail, whereas others are likely to prefer social media posts. Here are some ways to generate publicity and get people talking about your new business.



CASE STUDY

MUJI

Japanese retailer MUJI has been consistent in telling its "no brand" story through channels other than advertising. The company relies on publicity, in-store events, lectures that explain the thinking behind its products, and word of mouth. This quiet approach reflects the MUJI brand. The effect has been to set MUJI apart from its competitors and create a loyal following. MUJI now has stores from Singapore to New York.



BE CREATIVE

The point of PR is to get people interested in, and talking about, your business. Think of quirky ways to promote your brand that will capture the attention of others.

- › **Create posters and flyers** that will amuse or inspire those who see them. Make them available online for people to share and repost.
- › **Occasionally offer novelty** products or services, unique to your business.
- › **Launch innovative competitions**, such as local treasure hunts or online puzzles.



BE THE FACE OF YOUR BUSINESS

As business owner, you are central to your brand. Use your knowledge and enthusiasm to generate positive PR.

- › **Engage with local media** and develop a good relationship. Invite them to events, share stories, and send press releases.
- › **Become the expert** in your field to raise your personal profile and give greater credibility to your business.
- › **Speak publicly** at local and industry events. Join and start campaigns.

